by Philip Agee, also a former CIA officer. As a direct result of this case, a legislative process began that resulted in the 1982 passing of the Intelligence Identities Protection Act, which defines as a federal crime the exposure of the identity of a secret agent, including by a person who has legal access to classified information. Philip Agee was denounced both by the American media and by the judiciary. In Israel, however, following the publication of Victor Ostrovsky's book, which included the names of Mossad employees, no similar law was passed, and the Israeli media was more interested in interviewing him than in denouncing him.

The Invention Secrecy Act deals with patents, even those of private individuals, whose uncontrolled use may be detrimental to national security.

The Export Control Laws of 1976 limit exports that could harm state security if they were to reach an enemy or adversary.

The legal precedent of Grenada is particularly interesting. In a lawsuit filed against Secretary of Defense Weinberger, the court decided that a ruling on the issue was unnecessary since the media blackout had been lifted prior to the case being heard. However, if the court did have to rule, it would not be against the defendant, since such a ruling would limit the number of options available to commanders in the field, thereby jeopardizing the success of military operations, endangering human life, and severely harming national security.

Does the American norm with regard to the media and national security denote a healthy society? There is no doubt that the answer is yes—this is a healthy society in which there is a wall-to-wall consensus that certain information concerning national security must remain secret. Revealing everything means exposing the nation to risks and threats from potential enemies. On the other hand, in assessing the norms of the Israeli media, unfortunately I do recognize some symptoms of recklessness.

The exposure of military plans, strategy, military power, and deployment provides a huge advantage to a potential adversary. R&D of weapons systems, details of nuclear technologies, and the like can spell disaster if handed over to an adversary. The leaking of secrets about advanced technologies, such as lasers, kinetics, and computers, can mean the victory of one side over the other. The ban on scientific publications in the United States that deal with issues of strategic significance has become a bone of contention between the administration and academia, with the latter losing the struggle, even when academic freedom is at risk.